05-27 第一篇

The History of Paper Money

Before paper money, people traded with coins or valuable objects like shells and salt. Carrying heavy coins was difficult, especially for long journeys. In China, over a thousand years ago, merchants（商人）needed a lighter way to do business. [1] That is because they invented paper money to make trade easier. Paper bills could show large amounts of value without the weight of metal. The first paper money appeared in China during the Song Dynasty（宋朝）. It was called "jiaozi"（交子）and was used in Sichuan province. This invention changed how people thought about money. Paper money was light, easy to store, and convenient to use. Soon, the idea spread to other parts of the world.

How did paper money gain trust? [2] In other words, it had to be backed by something people valued. At first, paper money was a promise that you could exchange it for real gold or silver at a bank. The government or bank that issued（发行）the money had to keep enough gold or silver to support it. In this way, people trusted that the paper in their hands had real value. Today, most countries use "fiat money"—money that has value because the government says it does, not because it can be exchanged for gold. Trust in the government and the economy keeps paper money valuable.

Why does modern paper money have so many special designs? [3] That is why it includes many security features to prevent copying. Banknotes have special designs, watermarks（水印）, and threads that shine under light. Each country uses its own symbols, famous people, and landmarks on its money. The size, color, and material help people tell real money from fake（假的）money. That is why working in a bank often requires training to recognize counterfeit（伪造的）bills. Banks and governments work hard to stay ahead of counterfeiters. Security features are updated regularly to protect the economy.

Why might we use less paper money in the future? [4] It is true that digital payment has grown quickly. More and more people pay with phones, cards, and apps. In some countries, cash is used less often than before. Yet paper money is still important. Not everyone has a bank account or a smartphone. Cash is private and works without electricity or the Internet. So paper money will likely stay with us for a long time, even as digital payment becomes more common. The history of money is still being written.

[5] In short, paper money has a long and important history. From ancient China to the modern world, it has made trade easier and shaped how we live. Whether we pay with paper or a phone, the idea of money—representing value and trust—remains the same. So the next time you hold a banknote, remember: it carries centuries of human innovation and the trust of millions of people.

选项

A. That is because they invented paper money to make trade easier. B. In other words, it had to be backed by something people valued. C. That is why it includes many security features to prevent copying. D. It is true that digital payment has grown quickly. E. In conclusion, paper money has shaped human trade for centuries. F. For example, some ancient coins were made of copper or bronze.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：总领纸币发明的背景与动因。空前描述"Before paper money, people traded with coins or valuable objects...Carrying heavy coins was difficult...In China, over a thousand years ago, merchants needed a lighter way to do business"，空后说明"Paper bills could show large amounts of value without the weight of metal...The first paper money appeared in China during the Song Dynasty...This invention changed how people thought about money"。A选项"That is because they invented paper money to make trade easier"（那是因为他们发明了纸币以使贸易更便利）中"That is because"解释发明动机，"make trade easier"与空后lighter、easy to store、convenient精准对应，衔接顺畅。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：纸币如何获得信任——需有支撑。空前设问"How did paper money gain trust?"，空后详述"At first, paper money was a promise that you could exchange it for real gold or silver at a bank...The government or bank that issued the money had to keep enough gold or silver to support it...people trusted that the paper in their hands had real value...Trust in the government and the economy keeps paper money valuable"。B选项"In other words, it had to be backed by something people valued"（换言之，它必须由人们所珍视的东西来支撑）中"In other words"概括空后机制，"backed by something people valued"与空后gold or silver、support、trust完美呼应，衔接自然。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：现代纸币的防伪设计。空前设问"Why does modern paper money have so many special designs?"，空后列举"Banknotes have special designs, watermarks, and threads that shine under light...The size, color, and material help people tell real money from fake money...Banks and governments work

hard to stay ahead of counterfeiters...Security features are updated regularly"。C选项"That is why it includes many security features to prevent copying"（因此它包含许多防伪特征）中"That is why"承接空前问题，"security features to prevent copying"与空后special designs、watermarks、counterfeit精准对应，逻辑紧密。

- [4] D：
  - **线索**：未来纸币使用可能减少——数字支付兴起。空前设问"Why might we use less paper money in the future?"，空后说明"More and more people pay with phones, cards, and apps...In some countries, cash is used less often than before...paper money will likely stay with us for a long time, even as digital payment becomes more common"。D选项"It is true that digital payment has grown quickly"（的确，数字支付发展迅速）中"It is true that"引出原因，"digital payment has grown quickly"与空后phones, cards, and apps、cash is used less完美呼应，衔接得当。
- [5] E：
  - **线索**：全文收束与纸币历史的意义。空[5]位于结尾段段首，空后总结"paper money has a long and important history...From ancient China to the modern world, it has made trade easier and shaped how we live...the idea of money—representing value and trust—remains the same...it carries centuries of human innovation and the trust of millions of people"。E选项"In conclusion, paper money has shaped human trade for centuries"（总之，纸币已塑造了数百年的人类贸易）用"In conclusion"总结全文，"shaped human trade for centuries"与空后long and important history、centuries of human innovation形成呼应，收束有力。
- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. For example, some ancient coins were made of copper or bronze.**：涉及古代金属币材质，易被误填[1]或[2]。但F讨论的是硬币（coins），而空[1]聚焦纸币发明的动因，空[2]聚焦纸币信任机制；F与纸币主题脱节，属于"主题相关但论述对象错位"型干扰。